

5S Organized Work environment

U6 – Improve

E1 – Process Improvement Methods

The element 'Process Improvement Methods' sets out a series of methods and tools that can be used for process improvement, such as 5S, Kaizen, 8D, Theory of Constraints and Total Productive Maintenance.

Organized Work Environment

The five steps (5S)



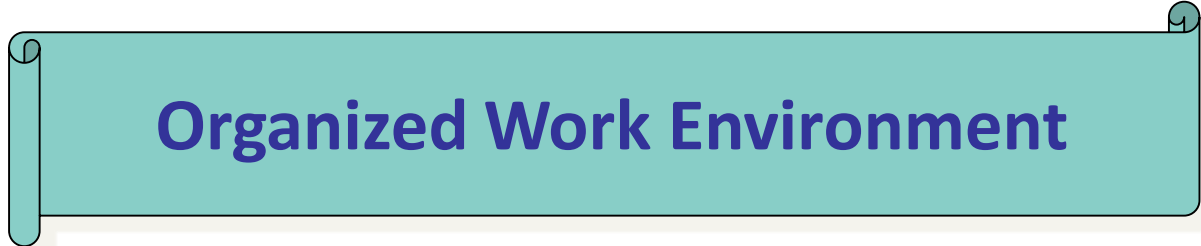
1. Sort
2. Straighten
3. Shine
4. Standardize
5. Sustain

To become 'World Class' it is essential to have a committed, disciplined approach towards good housekeeping

The 5S technique

- Exposes waste and prevents it from re-occurring in the future
- Communicates the operation standards of your company to all employees
- Improves workplace efficiency
- Contributes to a professional look

This technique is part of the set of techniques called:



Organized Work Environment

Organized Work Environment

5S

Sort

Nothing unnecessary at your workplace, remove anything not needed



Straighten

Everything has a fixed location



Shine

Keep everything you need continuously clean

Standardise

Make agreements, procedures and standards visible



Sustain

Be disciplined, follow-up on progress, assign owners to audit and stick to procedures

Determine scope

- **Select the area with most opportunities, afterwards spread**
- **Define target area**
Where can we achieve the biggest improvements?
Where is the chance of success high?
- **Fix start moment**
Develop an area map showing all work places, materials, etc.
Perform an initial audit
Photograph problem areas

Organized Work Environment

1 – Sort: Rough cleaning

Determine scope and team

- Set criterion or conditions before you start
- Clean-out anything that obviously does not belong in the area
- Reduce the number of items at your work location to only the things you need
- Discuss removal of items with all persons involved



‘Red Tag’ procedure

- Attach red tags to unneeded items (never needed / not needed for the time being)
- Clear out tagged items



Organized Work Eenvironment

1 – Sort: Rough cleaning

Where do you prefer to work?



Before



After

Organized Work Environment

2 – Straighten

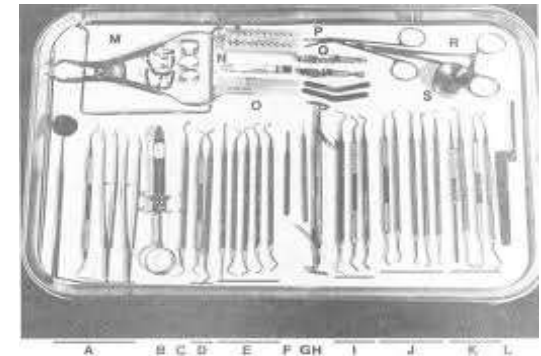
Give each item a fixed location

- Improve the efficiency of your current workflow
- Bring & keep same items together



Combine and group identical / similar items

- Writing material, phone, computer
- WIP – Work in progress
- Racks and boxes (incl. shapes and colours)
- Determine how much of each article should be available



Make it obvious where things belong

- Lines, labels, signs
- Show location, type, quantity, etc.



2 – Straighten

Frequency of Use	Storage/ location	Maximum Distance
continuous	on body / on workplace	max. 50 cm
every hour	on workplace	max. 1 meter
every day	near workplace	max. 5 meter
every week	in department	max. 10 meter
each month	in central warehouse	max. 250 meter
each year	in regional warehouse	
less than 1x per year	do you really need it?	

2 – Straighten - Example preconditions

- Common used items at fixed location
- Binders: in one location labelled
- Totes/ storage trays neatly labelled
- Label locations with red tape: a place for everything, everything in its place!



Organized Work Environment

2 – Straighten



3 – Shine

Keep your area continuously clean

- A clean workplace is an indicator of process quality
- Dust and dirt can cause contamination & health hazards
- A clean workplace helps to identify abnormal conditions

Clean everything, inside and outside

- Don't forget to also clean inside drawers, top of cabinets, keyboards, etc.
- Pay attention abnormalities (broken things, unsafe situations, etc.).

Inspect equipment and repair obvious shortcomings

- Make small reparations e.g. leakages, defective light bulbs
- Pay attention to missing / broken things, tape and noise

Eliminate all sources of contamination

- Prevent dirt, and contamination from reoccurring



3 – Shine

- After the first round of cleaning:
- Identify cleaning activities that need to be completed regularly
- Define roles and responsibilities
- Create and implement a cleaning scheme

**Take 5 minutes at the end
of each day/ shift for cleaning**



3 - Cleaning - Example preconditions

- Keep at least 40 cm free around everything that needs cleaning
- Clean desk: empty desks every day
- At the end of the day no coffee cups at the workplace
- Take 5 minutes time for cleaning and tidying up their own workplace at the end of the day
- Clean common areas (cleaning agency) - daily
- Clean desks agents (cleaning agency) - weekly



123RF Stock Photo

4 – Standardise

Standardise Sort, Straighten and Shine

- Establish guidelines for the team's 5S activities
- Make standards and 5S guidelines visible to continuously sustain sorting, storage and shining activities

Detect abnormalities

- Develop a system that will enable anyone in the workplace to see problems when they occur

Ensure safety, health, and well-being

- Ensure correct clothing, shoes, etc.
- Standardise safety items e.g. fire extinguisher, first aid kits



4 – Standardise

- Do not locate tall cabinets in the centre of the office/ room/ ward
- Keep the windows clear
- Clean wall: no posters on the wall



123RF Stock Photo

Organized Work Environment

5 – Sustain

Management is responsible for ensuring that guidelines are applied:

- Determine how the audit enforcement will be performed
- Management must give a good example ('walk the talk')
- Reward and appreciate improvements, act when it goes wrong
- Prepare an audit check list

Perform audits



Results of 5S

- Less stagnation
- Increased safety
- Better quality
- More usable space
- More satisfying work environment
- Easier to visualise the process
- Find everything you need in 20 seconds

**LESS
WASTE!**